

Inside a child's mind: As a peer educator with Expressions India, under VIMHANS, Pranav Sawhney (third from left) knows a lot about what ails his peer group. He and his friends bring out a journal, *Youthoriana*, to discuss issues and build bridges.



“Many of my friends hardly speak to their parents. They say they have nothing to talk about.”

Pranav Sawhney, 17, STUDENT, DPS VASANT KUNJ, DELHI

“As if parents have lost parenting skills.”



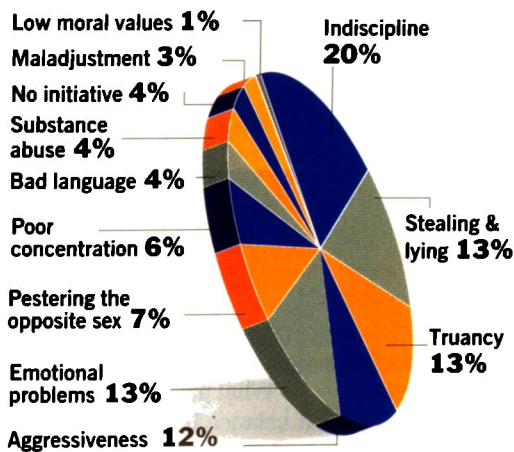
DR JITENDRA NAGPAL, PSYCHIATRIST, VIMHANS

“Parents over-react to every little thing today.”

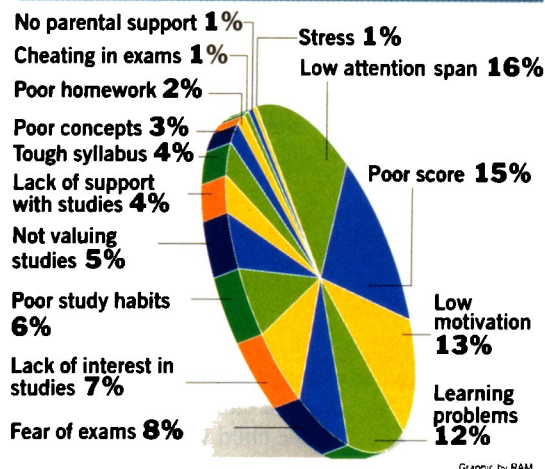


DEVI KAR, PRINCIPAL, MODERN HIGH SCHOOL, KOLKATA

BEHAVING BADLY IN SCHOOL...



STUDIES GOING FOR A TOSS...



Graphic by RAM

influence parents' buying decisions; 40 per cent have computers and mobile phones in 50 per cent Indian homes, point out Cartoon Network surveys between 2005 and 2007.

“Indian parents have always lived through their children,” points out psychoanalyst Sudhir Kakar. “But the stakes have never been higher. A child's success is particularly appealing now as a tool of redemption, mobility and glory for a family.” Middle India's obsession with fancy degrees and anxiety about the future is a real issue (remember the Chennai physician couple who allowed their 15-year-old son to carry out a Caesarean section in July 2007 in an attempt to set

a world record?) In a series of tests conducted on 2,000 school-going children, aged between 8-15 years, in Delhi, Mehta had asked them to list out 12 daily irritants. Studies, good grades, the need to succeed in life featured prominently. “Failure is one word that gives them continuous nightmares,” she says. “The problem is, parents don't give them credit for any other activity they excel in besides studies.”

Devi Kar, principal of Modern High School, Kolkata, is familiar with the dilemma of high expectations and overindulgence. “When I started teaching 38 years ago, students expected teachers to scold them and did not take offence.

Source: VIMHANS surveys by Dr Jitendra Nagpal, 2004-07